NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Senior Platform / Site Reliability Engineer

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior platform and site reliability engineer with 10 years of infrastructure experience, including six years running Kubernetes platforms on AWS and leading a Karpenter and spot migration that reduced EC2 spend by 38%. Experienced in designing, building and operating cloud infrastructure, maintaining Terraform-based infrastructure as code, and leading technical topics from proposal through production, while building self-service platforms, observability and incident practices that help product teams deliver reliable services.

LANGUAGES

English (native); Urdu (conversational)

Technical Toolkit

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront), cloud infrastructure design and operation, Terraform, Atlantis
Platform engineering: Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, Argo CD, Crossplane, Karpenter, GitHub Actions
Reliability and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, SLOs and error budgets, incident management, k6
Programming and systems: Go, Python, Bash, Linux, Puppet

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer - Tallybrook Ltd, Manchester, United Kingdom / remote *Apr 2022 - Present*

- Tech lead of a five-person platform team operating an AWS EKS platform across eight clusters and three regions, supporting approximately 350 services.
- Built an internal developer platform with golden-path service templates, Argo CD GitOps and Crossplane self-service for RDS, SQS and S3; adopted by all 14 product teams and reduced time from new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day.
- Led technical implementation of Karpenter and spot instances for stateless workloads, reducing EC2 spend by 38% (approximately GBP 410,000 per year).
- Established SLOs, burn-rate alerts and error budget policies for the 20 most critical services in agreement with product leadership; reduced on-call pages per week by approximately 60%. Participate in the incident commander rotation and established the incident and post-mortem process.

Site Reliability Engineer - Brightwater Games, Leeds *Jan 2019 - Mar 2022*

- Operated AWS game backend infrastructure using EC2, ECS and EKS for titles with up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed AWS infrastructure as code using approximately 40 Terraform modules and Atlantis plan/apply workflows on pull requests.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki observability.
- Ran k6 load tests and capacity planning ahead of launches; a test simulating 300,000 concurrent players exposed a connection pool limit that was fixed before launch.

SELECTED PROJECTS AND CONTRIBUTIONS

- Open-source Kubernetes cleanup controller: built a Go controller-runtime project to delete expired preview namespaces; approximately 120 GitHub stars.
- Shared SLO practices at a UK DevOps meetup in 2024 with the talk “SLOs that product managers care about”.
- Mentored three engineers moving from backend development into SRE.

EDUCATION & TRAINING

BSc Computer Science - University of the North Moors, 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA), renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Professional, 2023